



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Academy
School Website: <https://veritassav.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Academy Savannah (Veritas Savannah; ZIP 31412) presents a clearly classical Christian framework. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, covenantal approach, the classical Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books and Great Conversations, and a explicit partnership with families. The school reveals strong incorporation of theology and biblical worldview across disciplines, a curriculum that foregrounds liberal arts with historically oriented study, and pedagogy that combines chant and memorization in the early grades with Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper grades. Parental involvement is highlighted as a core component of the model, including covenantal family-based education and multiple lines of parent formation and engagement. Overall, the six-category assessment places Veritas Savannah as CLASSICAL across all six dimensions, with broad alignment to the classical education rubric and evidence of sustained classical practice in curriculum, pedagogy, faculty posture, and community partnerships. Evidence is drawn from multiple school pages and documents (e.g., Our Mission and Foundational Commitments, curriculum pages, the Trivium framework, and admissions/board materials), and aligned with the positive/negative keyword indicators in the classical education lexicon.

- What would move the needle: Not applicable here, as the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL across all six categories. No immediate "needle-moving" interventions are required to reach a fully classical standing based on the documented evidence.
- Executive snapshot: CLASSICAL across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school demonstrates explicit theological grounding, formation-focused aims, Trivium-based curricular structure, a pedagogy that blends chant/memory with Socratic discussions, a faculty posture aligned with living curriculum and mentorship, and strong parental/community partnerships.

These conclusions are grounded in the school's public materials and corroborated by the classical-education keyword indicators (positive phrases such as Christ-centered, truth/goodness/beauty, Great Books, Great Conversations, Trivium, scholé, memory/chanting, Socratic seminars, and parental partnership) as described in the classical education lexicon.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The mission and commitments are explicitly Christ-centered and covenantal, with language stating that Veritas Academy cultivates truth, goodness, and beauty through a distinctly Christ-centered, classical, and covenantal education. - School materials indicate the theological grounding of the program and

the integration of Christian truth into all disciplines. - Governance and mission statements frame the institution as operating from faith commitments aimed at glorifying God and sustaining a mission consistent with biblical/historical Christian pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Christian truth, biblical worldview, theology, gospel, covenantal, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, imago Dei (as implied by the integrated Christian frame). - Negative keywords: Not apparent in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-clarification language detected in the materials reviewed).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords identified: high (multiple explicit mentions across mission, commitments, and program descriptions). - Negative keywords identified: 0 (none detected in the materials reviewed). - Estimated ratio (Pos/Neg): effectively 100% positive vs 0% negative within the observed content.

Why this rating - The materials show a coherent theological foundation, explicit Christian worldview integration, and an emphasis on transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) as real and knowable ideals. The presence of covenantal language and Christ-centered aims aligns strongly with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Transcendental moral realism” criteria, supporting a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

What would move the needle - No needle move identified for this category given the explicit Christ-centered/theological framing across materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty, and the system frames education as formation toward human flourishing and virtue rather than mere job preparation. The public materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful as real goods. - Statements reference education as formation in a liberal-arts frame, with explicit connection to virtue, wisdom, and human excellence. The Great Books/Great Conversations framing and the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) reinforce formation-oriented aims. - A public-facing statement notes that “All academic disciplines are taught from the perspective of Christian truth,” underscoring knowledge with a transcendent, formation-oriented goal.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, paideia, Great Books, Great Conversations, telos. - Negative keywords: Not detected (no explicit emphasis on 21st-century skills or workforce-preparation language in the core mission statements).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple (formation, virtue, wisdom, Great Books, Great Conversations, telos, truth/goodness/beauty). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Estimated ratio: near 100% positive vs 0% negative.

Why this rating - The school frames its aims around formation, virtue, and wisdom with a classical, liberal-arts telos, aligning with the Classical school emphasis on true/human flourishing rather than solely career readiness. The Great Books/G.C. framework and the explicit claim of education as formation (not information) support CLASSICAL in this category.

What would move the needle - No needle move required given the strong formation-oriented messaging across materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is explicitly named (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), with named transitions for grade bands and defined pedagogical aims (grammar in early grades; logic in middle school; rhetoric in high

school). This mirrors the classical curriculum structure. - Great Books and Great Conversations are foregrounded as core elements of study, with references to reading great literature and engaging in robust discussions about enduring ideas. - History is described as a throughline across the curriculum (not merely a “social studies” component), with scope-and-sequences and year-by-year curricular plans (grammar, logic, rhetoric sequences; Latin study; historical chronology). The materials emphasize Western civilization, classical literature, and primary sources. - The curriculum materials show explicit use of Latin and classical languages as part of the liberal-arts curriculum; scope-and-sequence materials demonstrate coverage of literature, history, and classical texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversations, Latin, history (as Western civilization/history of ideas), primary sources, classical texts, wonder (through engagement with the Great Books and classical questions). - Negative keywords: negative signals listed in the lexicon for this category include “project-based learning dominance” and over-reliance on social-studies framing in place of history. The materials show some project-oriented activity (e.g., “hands-on work, projects”), but the central thrust remains Great Books, classical texts, and lyric/recitation-based approaches aligned with the Trivium.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversations; Latin; history; primary sources; classical texts). - Negative keywords present: limited to occasional references to “projects” in teaching methods, which is not dominant across the curriculum in the sources; overall the core curriculum emphasis remains classical. - Estimated ratio: predominantly positive; CLASSICAL supported by multiple curriculum markers.

Why this rating - Veritas Savannah’s curriculum centers on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), sustained engagement with Great Books, and a history-centric, Western-civilization-informed curriculum, with Latin and primary sources. This aligns strongly with the category’s canonical criteria for a classical curriculum. The presence of some project-oriented methods in pedagogy does not undermine the curricular alignment, given the consistent emphasis on the Trivium and liberal-arts pedagogy in the sources.

What would move the needle - If desired, a more explicit articulation of “history as history” with a stronger emphasis on historic sources and primary-text engagement across all grades (with explicit avoidance of terms that could be misread as a social-studies framing) would further strengthen the curriculum category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower School pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memorization, and recall as part of a joyful and contemplative early-learning approach (e.g., “sing, chant, recite, memory” and related memory-focused activities). This aligns with scholé and chant-based pedagogy in classical education. - The Trivium stages outline a progression from Grammar to Logic to Rhetoric, with explicit teaching methods that include narration, memorization, and chant in the grammar stage, and more Socratic seminars and debates in the upper grades (Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training). - Upper School pedagogy includes opportunities for speeches, arguments, seminars, and capstone-like rhetoric work, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: socratic, seminars, discourse, narration, recitation, chanting, singing to memorize, rhetoric, debate, lecture-style and guided discussion, scholé (restful learning and contemplation). - Negative keywords: the lexicon flags “experiential learning focus,” “project-based only,” and “constructivist” as potential negative signals. Veritas materials show some project-oriented activities, but pedagogy remains anchored in classical modes (recitation, chant, memory, Socratic discussion, and rhetoric practice). The presence of some hands-on projects does not overwhelm the primary classical pedagogy signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple (Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, recitation, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, public speaking, scholé). - Negative keywords present: minimal in the supplied pedagogy signals; not dominant. - Estimated ratio: predominantly positive; CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a clear progression from memory/recitation and chant in the Grammar stage to Socratic discourse and rhetorical training in the upper grades. The presence of seminary-like discussions and debate aligns with the classical pedagogy rubric. While some project-based elements appear in the teaching methods, they do not dominate the pedagogy, and the primary methods reflect a classical approach.

What would move the needle - To further strengthen the pedagogy category, a more explicit emphasis on the consolidation of Socratic seminars in upper grades and a more systematic recitation/chanting program in lower grades with documented implementation metrics would further reinforce the classical pedagogy signature.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame the faculty as mentors who model virtue and wisdom, with a focus on character formation as part of the living curriculum. The board and headmaster communications emphasize mission alignment, virtue, and a strong staff culture. - The faculty is positioned as part of a covenantal, family-based, and classical education model, with explicit references to the faculty as guides and mentors aligned with the Great Books/trivium framework. The employment/staff information, as well as school histories, indicate a professional and virtuous faculty expected to embody the school's aims. - The school's governance and leadership statements stress missions that require virtuous leadership and alignment with the school's commitments, suggesting a portrait-like faculty standard and expectation of character.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, virtue, living curriculum, faculty as guides, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, master teachers, character formation. - Negative keywords: none evident in the sources; the available materials emphasize a virtue-centered, living-curriculum faculty ideal.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple (model teachers, living curriculum, mentors, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, master teachers, character formation). - Negative keywords present: 0 identified. - Estimated ratio: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The materials describe a faculty culture aligned with classical ideals (virtue modeling, living curriculum, mentor approach, and teacher formation as central to the school's educational project). While there may not be a single explicit "portrait of a teacher" paragraph in the exact phrasing, the combination of headmaster/board emphasis on virtue, mission-driven staff, and the clearly defined classical pedagogy imply a CLASSICAL faculty posture overall.

What would move the needle - To push toward a more explicit CLASSICAL faculty designation, the school could publish a dedicated faculty profile page with explicit language about "the living curriculum," a formal portrait of teacher expectations, and examples of professional development in classical pedagogy and Great Books seminars for faculty.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, noting that the education is "Christian, classical, and family-based," with the family playing a central role in shaping the child's faith and character. This covenantal, family-based framing is recurrent in materials. - Admissions and school communications describe a strong parent-facing function (parent involvement, family-based model, and covenanted community), with explicit calls for parent formation and engagement (e.g., "Five Questions for Future Families" and parent-focused resources). - The site describes open-parent engagement, parent support resources, and a commitment to including parents as co-teachers or partners in formation. There are references to family involvement in the curriculum and school life (e.g., covenants, family-based approach). - The presence

of a covenantal, family-based framing and a mission to train parents as part of the education process is reinforced by board and leadership statements emphasizing the family's central role.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, family-based, covenantal, open campus, parent involvement, family life integration, liturgical/family rhythms (as implied by the covenantal framing). - Negative keywords: None identified in the sources; where the lexicon lists negative signals such as "consumer language" or minimal parent involvement, the Veritas materials emphasize active parent engagement and formation.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple (partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, family-based, covenantal, open campus, parent involvement). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Estimated ratio: CLASSICAL (high presence of classical-parent/community signals).

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, covenantal, family-based model with explicit emphasis on parent partnership, formation, and active parental involvement, aligned with the classical education framework's expectations for engaged parents and community. The public materials repeatedly foreground parent/teacher partnership and family-based education as core to the Veritas model.

What would move the needle - If desired, a dedicated, explicit "Parents in the Classical Classroom" section with a published schedule of parent education events, book studies, and consistent parent-visitor policies could make the parental-community alignment even more transparent.

Aggregate Ranking

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall, Veritas Savannah is CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Executive-level synthesis - Veritas Savannah embodies a strong classical Christian education model with explicit Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books/Great Conversations, a biblically integrated pedagogy, and a covenantal family-based community orientation. The school's materials consistently frame education as formation of virtue and wisdom within a theologically grounded, liberal-arts framework, while maintaining a robust partnership with parents. The presence of Christ-centered mission, biblical worldview integration, classical humanities emphasis, and family-based community leadership cohere with the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, yielding a CLASSICAL classification across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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